Australia. Conversely, a “negative” SAM event reflects an equatorward expansion of the belt of strong westerly winds. This shift in the westerly winds results in more storm systems and lower pressure over southern Australia.

It is interesting to note that there appears to be an increasing trend in the SAM. During the summer and autumn months (December through to May) the SAM shows an increasing tendency to remain in a positive phase, with westerly winds contracted towards the south pole.

70. The sub-tropical ridge brings dry and stable conditions to large parts of Australia.

Explanation (67)

